

Sriram Venkataraman

Lead / Staff Quality Engineer

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Professional Summary

Sixteen years in quality engineering — the last five at FanDuel, where I own the test strategy and Quality Maturity Model for 21 teams across 3 pillars and 3 geographic locations, building the testing platform behind the Sportsbook apps on iOS, Android, and web. I lead without authority: defining the quality gates, exit criteria, and release-readiness signals teams ship against, running testing-efficiency audits and a QA Community of Practice, and embedding with feature squads rather than sitting apart from them — so quality maturity is something every team owns. The engineering sits a layer beneath the product: AI-driven test automation, statistical performance-regression detection, cross-platform native E2E and real-device visual regression, feature-flag test control, and CI fast enough that teams keep it in their loop. Earlier I built UI and API automation frameworks from scratch and led offshore test teams across insurance and financial-services clients.

21 Teams on the quality model	3 × 3 Pillars × locations	16 yrs In quality engineering	~70% Faster CI feedback	55%→70% Codebase test coverage
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Quality Leadership & Governance

I lead without formal authority. Nobody reports to me, but the test strategy, quality gates, and shift-left standards for 21 teams across 3 pillars and 3 geographic locations are mine to define — and adopted by embedding with squads, not mandating from a distance.

Influence at scale: Drive shift-left and test-automation adoption across 21 teams, 3 pillars, 3 geographic locations — with no direct reports; Bridge the central Quality Engineering Capabilities team and feature squads; Partner with pillar-level Staff QAs toward one unified quality strategy

Governance: Define quality gates and exit criteria squads ship against; Provide release-readiness / go-no-go input at release time

Enablement: Run a QA Community of Practice; Run testing-efficiency audits — coverage gaps, flaky-test patterns, automation opportunities; Sit in 3 Amigos / refinement to shape acceptance criteria and edge cases up front; Onboard squads with documentation and hands-on support

Organisational: Interview and hire quality engineers; Lead POC-driven tool evaluation and selection for the org's testing stack; Proactively introduce new capability — AI-driven test automation is the clearest example

Skills

Quality Governance & Programme Leadership: Release readiness / go-no-go criteria, Quality gates & exit criteria, Testing efficiency audits (coverage gaps, flaky tests), QA Community of Practice, 3 Amigos / refinement participation, Cross-team test strategy, Quality reporting to senior leadership, Distributed-team collaboration (3 locations), POC-led tool evaluation & selection

Test Strategy & Architecture: Quality Maturity Model (testing pillars & layers), Shift-left / defect prevention, Test pyramid & strategy, Test data strategy, Contract testing, Feature-flag testing, Gray-box / screen-object patterns, BDD / Gherkin standards, Accessibility testing, Mentoring & enablement

Test Management & Delivery: System integration testing (SIT), User acceptance testing (UAT), Risk-based & exploratory testing, Test estimation & planning, Test design optimisation, Defect management & triage, Capacity planning & work allocation, Onshore–offshore coordination, Stakeholder status reporting

Mobile & E2E Automation: Detox (React Native), Appium / WebdriverIO, Maestro (mobile flows), wix-pilot (AI / NLP tests), BrowserStack App Percy (visual regression), Device farm management, Cypress, Jest / RTL

Performance & Reliability: Perf regression detection (E-Disivise), Baseline validation & anomaly detection, iOS / Android perf instrumentation, Datadog metrics & events, Sentry (crash reporting & alerting), SLOs & error budgets

CI/CD & Infrastructure: Buildkite, GitHub Actions, Test parallelization (Jest sharding), Build caching (hybrid iOS), Terraform / AWS (S3, IAM, Bedrock), Azure DevOps, Docker

Web & API Automation: Protractor, Cucumber, Selenium WebDriver, SpecFlow, ReadyAPI, Postman, Mountebank / WireMock

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Bash, C#, Groovy, SQL

AI Engineering

Tools: Claude / Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot

Practices: Plan-and-implement (spec-first) agentic workflows, Multi-agent orchestration, Authoring reusable agent skills, Natural-language test automation (wix-pilot, cy.prompt)

- **Performance Impact Review:** A multi-agent skill that turns a raw performance change-point report into a validated review — pinpointing the commit range behind each regression, analysing the diff for performance concerns, adversarially verifying findings, and producing an actionable remediation plan. Reusable by any team triaging performance reports.
- **Acceptance-Test Debugger:** An agent skill that diagnoses failing native acceptance tests end to end — environment diagnostics, build/test config alignment, and failure-artifact analysis (screenshots, videos, reports) — and self-updates its known-error playbook as new issues are solved. Useful to any engineer debugging flaky or failing E2E tests.

Work Experience

Lead Quality Engineer — Sportsbook, FanDuel

2022 – Present

Edinburgh, UK

- Own the test strategy and Quality Maturity Model (pillars, layers, maturity levels) for 21 teams across 3 pillars and 3 geographic locations, spanning iOS, Android, and web.
- Define the quality gates, exit criteria, and release-readiness signals the Sportsbook apps ship against — go/no-go input without holding sign-off authority.
- Run a QA Community of Practice and quarterly-style testing-efficiency audits (coverage gaps, flaky-test patterns), sit in 3 Amigos/refinement, report quality status to senior leadership, interview and hire QEs, and lead POC-driven tool evaluation and selection for the org's testing stack.
- Built a Python E-Disivise + Datadog performance-regression detector that gates CI with under 2% false-positive noise and Slack alerting.
- Pioneered AI-driven E2E testing by integrating wix-pilot — tests authored in natural language over a reusable prompt library, not imperative code.
- Cut native test runs ~70% (4-way Buildkite/Jest sharding) and test-build time ~80% (180m→30m) via build sharing + a hybrid git-aware cache, backed by Terraform S3 + Bedrock infra.

- Built cross-platform native E2E (Appium/WebdriverIO + Detox) and launch-argument testability — runtime env switching, mock injection, feature-flag overrides, and testIDs in prod.
- Built BrowserStack App Percy visual regression across a real-device matrix (iOS + Android) and own the BrowserStack device-farm estate other squads test against.
- Introduced SonarCloud PR quality gates (coverage, readability, maintainability, security) that lifted codebase coverage 55%→70% and cut duplication 45%→20%.

Senior Quality Engineer — Sportsbook, FanDuel

2021 – 2022

Edinburgh, UK

- Authored the Detox acceptance framework, screen-object patterns, and onboarding docs, and stood up the foundational CI test pipelines and Datadog observability later work built on.

Lead / Senior Test Analyst — Automation, Cognizant Technology Solutions

Jul 2017 – 2021

Edinburgh, UK

- Built UI and API automation frameworks from scratch (Protractor–Cucumber–TypeScript; ReadyAPI + Groovy assertion library) and the Azure DevOps pipelines to run them — Royal London, Resonate Tech.
- Owned a program-wide UI framework uplift — hardened test reliability and built failure-analysis reporting into the Azure pipelines.
- Tested newly built microservices against stubbed environments (Mountebank, WireMock, Swagger-driven mock data; Docker via DockerHub/Portainer) before integration was available.
- Delivered an accessibility-regression framework that cut accessibility regression effort ~40%, plus a UI error-handling/mocking framework.
- Shifted testing left into refinement — static-tested requirements and raised ambiguities with the PO before stories entered the backlog, and drafted the Gherkin E2E scenarios used as CI/CD acceptance tests.
- Diagnosed defects on integrated environments through Splunk log analysis, and fixed minor application bugs with their accompanying unit tests.
- Authored Gherkin standards adopted across Test/BA/Dev and trained clients and peers to scale automation.

Offshore Test Lead / Senior Test Analyst, Cognizant Technology Solutions

Jan 2010 – Jul 2017

Chennai & Coimbatore, India

- Led a 7-member offshore test team for Voya Financial — capacity planning, cross-module KT, and status reporting across five modules.
- Kick-started automation with a Selenium/TestNG POC and Excel-macro tooling; delivered functional/regression testing for Travelers and Lincoln Financial.

Selected Accomplishments

Full case studies — problem, approach, and impact for each — sriramvenkataraman-portfolio.vercel.app

- **Performance Regression Detector:** Built a Python E-Divisive + Datadog perf-regression detector gating CI with <2% noise and Slack alerting (iOS & Android).
- **AI-Driven Test Automation:** Pioneered AI-driven testing — wix-pilot+Detox, Cypress cy.prompt(), Appium+Wix Pilot on BrowserStack — authoring E2E tests in natural language across native and web.
- **Cross-Platform Native E2E:** Built a 58-spec Appium/WebdriverIO + Detox E2E suite (iOS & Android) on real devices for core betting flows.
- **CI Acceleration:** Cut native test runs ~70% (4-way Buildkite/Jest sharding) and test-build time ~80% (180m→30m) via build sharing + a hybrid git-aware cache.

- **Launch-Argument Testability:** Built launch-argument testability (runtime env switching, mock injection, testIDs-in-prod) via a native Swift/Kotlin + RN module — reused by Casino.
- **Feature-Flag Test Control:** Extended launch-argument testability to carry feature-flag overrides (surviving Android deeplink relaunch) — deterministic flag-on/off testing with zero rebuilds, adopted as the standard across acceptance and E2E suites.
- **Visual Regression at Device-Matrix Scale:** Built BrowserStack App Percy visual regression across a 10-device real-device matrix (iOS + Android) for a fast-moving home-page redesign — POC-selected tooling, ~5-week delivery, adopted by 3 squads.
- **Device Farm Ownership & Enablement:** Own the BrowserStack device-farm estate and integration patterns other squads test against — real-device matrix, onboarding, and POC-led tool evaluation.
- **QA Environment Smoke Framework:** Built a QA-environment smoke framework that automated detection of 76+ recurring failures (across 5 categories) previously caught manually.
- **Build-Cache & AI Test Infrastructure:** Provisioned the Terraform S3 build-cache (lifecycle + least-privilege IAM) and multi-region Bedrock access powering CI.
- **Org-Wide Quality Strategy & Governance:** Own test strategy, quality gates/exit criteria, and the shift-left Quality Maturity Model (40+ docs) for 21 teams across 3 pillars and 3 locations — QA Community of Practice, efficiency audits, and release-readiness input.
- **SonarCloud Quality Gates:** Introduced SonarCloud PR quality gates (coverage, readability, maintainability, security) that lifted codebase coverage 55%→70% and cut duplication 45%→20%.

Earlier Career Highlights — Cognizant (2010–2021)

- **Mocked & Stubbed Environment Testing:** Tested microservices against stubbed environments (Mountebank/WireMock, Swagger-driven mock data, Docker via DockerHub/Portainer, AWS S3 & Cognito) and built a Protractor UI error-mocking framework that made error paths automatable.
- **Program-Level UI Framework Uplift:** Owned a program-wide UI framework uplift — hardened test reliability and built in-pipeline failure-analysis reporting in Azure DevOps.
- **Accessibility Regression Automation:** Built a Protractor accessibility-regression framework integrated into Azure CI/CD, cutting regression effort ~40%.
- **API Test Framework & Assertion Library:** Built a ReadyAPI test framework with a custom Groovy assertion library, reused widely for end-to-end functional testing.
- **Offshore Test Leadership & Enablement:** Led a 7-member offshore test team, seeded Selenium/TestNG automation, and rolled out Gherkin standards across disciplines.

Personal Projects

- **Scorebook App:** React Native / Expo + Node.js/Express monorepo built solo with AI assistance — Maestro mobile flows, GitHub Actions CI. A documented experiment to validate AI-first single-person startup claims.
- **Flag Explorer Game:** Vanilla JS multi-level flag quiz with country facts, built for my daughter. Zero dependencies, deployed on Vercel. flag-explorer.vercel.app
- **Birthday RSVP & Memory Share:** Vanilla JS + Vite RSVP site for my daughter's 9th birthday — guest attendance, allergy capture, and host-curated post-party photo sharing. Deployed on Vercel.
- **CricBuds Prediction Game:** Next.js + Neon DB cricket score prediction game for our Edinburgh East of Scotland league group — season-long leaderboard. cricbuds.vercel.app

Education & Certifications

B.E. Mechanical Engineering, Anna University

2005 – 2009

Certifications: ISTQB Foundation Level Certified

“Ship fast or ship good” is a false choice.

Every team I've worked with was told they had to pick one. Building the right testing platform is how they stopped having to. Let's talk.

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